

STRATEGY ENGAGEMENT · BOARD REVIEW

Where Value Hides in the Market for Small Internet Businesses

An analysis of 1,000 listings on TrustMRR — the marketplace where founders sell profitable internet businesses

Dataset frozen 30 July 2026 · 1,000 listings · 29 fields

A liquid market for small internet businesses now exists — but it prices assets on one month of revenue, concentrating opportunity in the buyers who normalise it.



The market is thinner than it looks

Listings are abundant; revenue is not. A small minority of listings carries almost all the economic value.

Slides 6–9



Business model beats category

Pricing model, audience and persona explain revenue durability far better than what the product actually does.

Slides 10–15



The pricing mechanism is broken — knowably

The headline multiple annualises a single month, creating a predictable and exploitable spread.

Slides 16–21

THREE MOVES FOLLOW

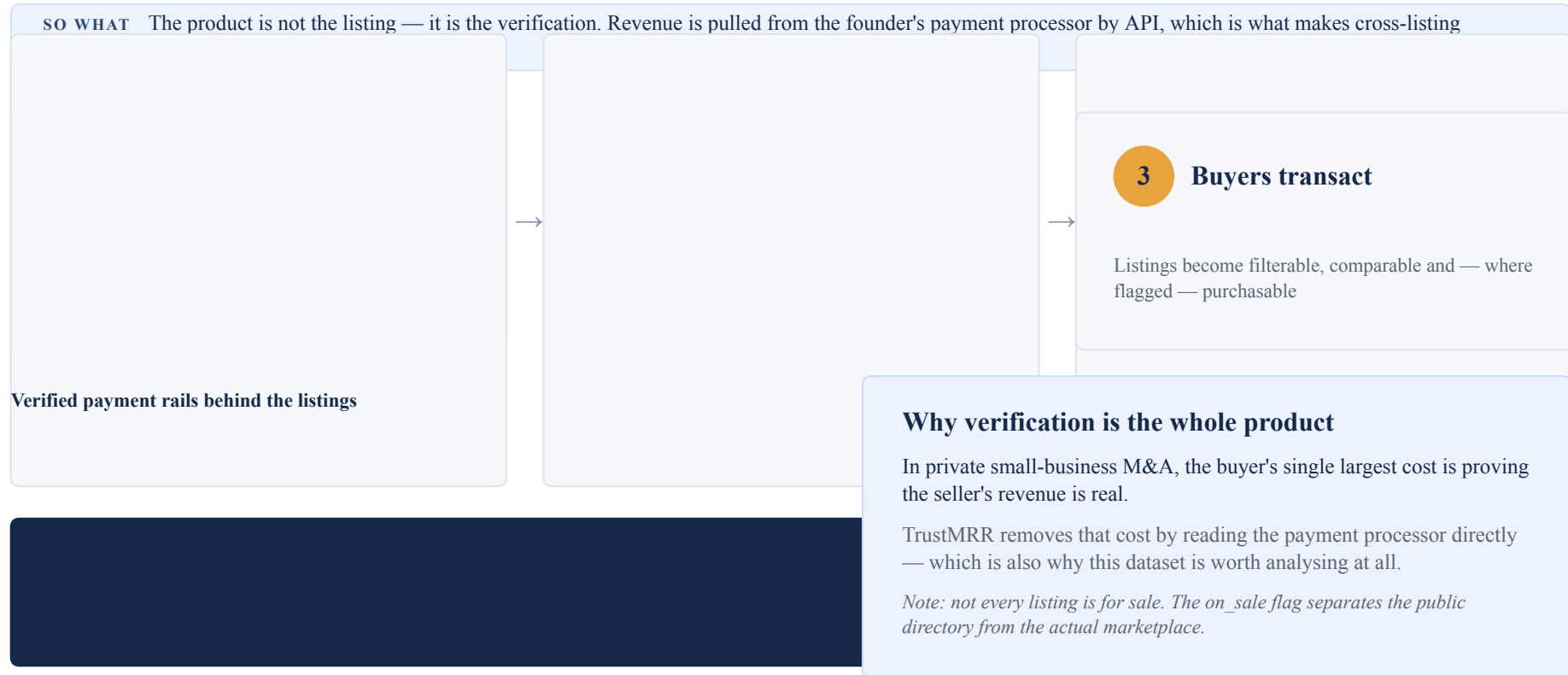
Screen on twelve-month revenue, not the platform multiple · Weight recurring revenue over headline revenue · Treat traffic quality, not traffic volume, as the growth signal

01

What is TrustMRR?

A market that did not exist five years ago — and why it deserves board attention

TrustMRR turns private, unverifiable side businesses into publicly comparable assets by connecting directly to their payment systems.



Columns: payment_provider, trustmrr_url, website, on_sale, record_id. Calculation: share of listings by provider; share where on_sale = TRUE. Provider mix illustrative — compute from data.

Most listings are liquidity events, not distress sales — the supply side is dominated by small, healthy, founder-fatigued assets.

SO WHAT The dominant seller is a solo founder with a working product, no team, and a better use of their next twelve months. That profile is what makes these assets acquirable — and what limits how big they get.

Failure is the minority case

Only one of the four seller archetypes involves a broken business. The other three are choices.

The build-to-boredom cycle

Solo founders build these in months and lose interest in years. The asset outlives the enthusiasm.

The quadrant that should worry a buyer

Real revenue with zero active subscriptions usually means one-time or service revenue that does not carry forward to the new owner.

Strategic pivot

Healthy asset, founder's attention has moved on to a new project

Portfolio rotation

Growing asset sold deliberately to recycle capital into the next build

Genuine distress

Declining revenue, founder disengaged — the smallest of the four groups

Founder fatigue

Flat or slowly declining, still earning, founder simply done

FOUNDER COMMITMENT → DISENGAGED

BUSINESS HEALTH: DECLINING → GROWING

Columns: on_sale, revenue_growth_30d_pct, mrr_usd, active_subscriptions, asking_price_usd. Calculation: segment_on_sale = TRUE by growth sign and subscription density; report share still growing.

WHY DOES THIS MARKET MATTER?

Below the threshold where private equity and investment banks operate, TrustMRR is the only price discovery mechanism that exists.

SO WHAT A structural gap has been filled. Businesses too small for a banker and too real to abandon now have a route to liquidity — which changes how founders build and creates a new asset class for small buyers.

\$0 – \$1K

ABANDONED

No market existed. Founder switches off the server.

\$1K – \$1M

TRUSTMRR / MICRO-ACQUISITION

The new middle. Verified metrics, standard terms, self-serve.

PE & INVESTMENT BANKING

Established process, advisers, diligence, negotiated terms.

DEAL VALUE (log scale) →

Where this dataset physically sits

The upstream effect

Once an exit route exists at this size, founder behaviour changes before the exit: people build to sell, instrument revenue early, and connect a payment processor on day one.

Liquidity is what turns a project into an asset class.

Columns: asking_price_usd. Calculation: distribution for on_sale = TRUE — median, p25, p75, p90; share priced under \$50K. Bar shape illustrative — compute from data.

02

The dataset

What we can honestly claim — and what we cannot

1,000 listings and 29 fields — but the analytically rich fields are populated for only a minority, so conclusions come from the populated core, not the full census.

SO WHAT Treat this as a directional map of a market, not an audited financial database. Every downstream conclusion is stated on a named subset and sized accordingly.

The financial spine is trustworthy

Revenue, MRR and subscriptions are API-verified from the payment processor.

The descriptive skin is not

Category, persona and value proposition are founder-written marketing copy, carrying positioning bias.

Traffic data is thin

Visitor and revenue-per-visitor columns are sparse, so Section 5 is directional and stated on a named subset.

Watch the stealth rows

Listings with no name, website or country. Keep for revenue analysis; exclude from geography and category cuts.

* Populated only where on_sale = TRUE. Calculation: fill rate = non-null count ÷ 1,000, per column. Fill rates illustrative — compute from data before presenting.

03

Market landscape

What is listed, who lists it, and where the value actually sits

The market is a power law: roughly half of all listings generate no revenue at all — the economic weight sits in a thin top decile.

SO WHAT Listing volume is a vanity metric. Any market sizing, category ranking or geographic claim must be revenue-weighted, or it describes a market that does not economically exist.

~50%

of listings report zero twelve-month revenue

Higher still

the share reporting zero MRR — many earning businesses are simply not subscription

Top 10%

carries the overwhelming majority of all revenue on the platform

Columns: revenue_12m_usd, mrr_usd, revenue_all_time_usd. Calculation: Lorenz curve and Gini on revenue_12m_usd; revenue share of top decile and top percentile. Curve shape illustrative.

WHICH CATEGORIES DOMINATE?

ILLUSTRATIVE SHAPE

AI, SaaS and Productivity dominate listing volume — but that reflects low build cost, not demand.

SO WHAT Category crowding signals ease of building, not attractiveness of the market. High listing share with low median revenue is a warning, not an endorsement.

Listings by category (count)

Median 12-month revenue for the same categories (US\$)

Columns: category, markets_json, revenue_12m_usd, mrr_usd. Calculation: count and median (never mean) revenue per category; report blanks as an explicit 'Uncategorised' bar. Values illustrative.

Value concentrates in unglamorous categories — the strongest per-listing economics are not where the listings are.

SO WHAT Target the high-value, low-crowding quadrant. Categories that are hard to build in are exactly the ones where a built asset is worth buying rather than rebuilding.

Split at the medians, not at zero

State the split values on the slide so the quadrants are auditable by anyone in the room.

Suppress thin categories

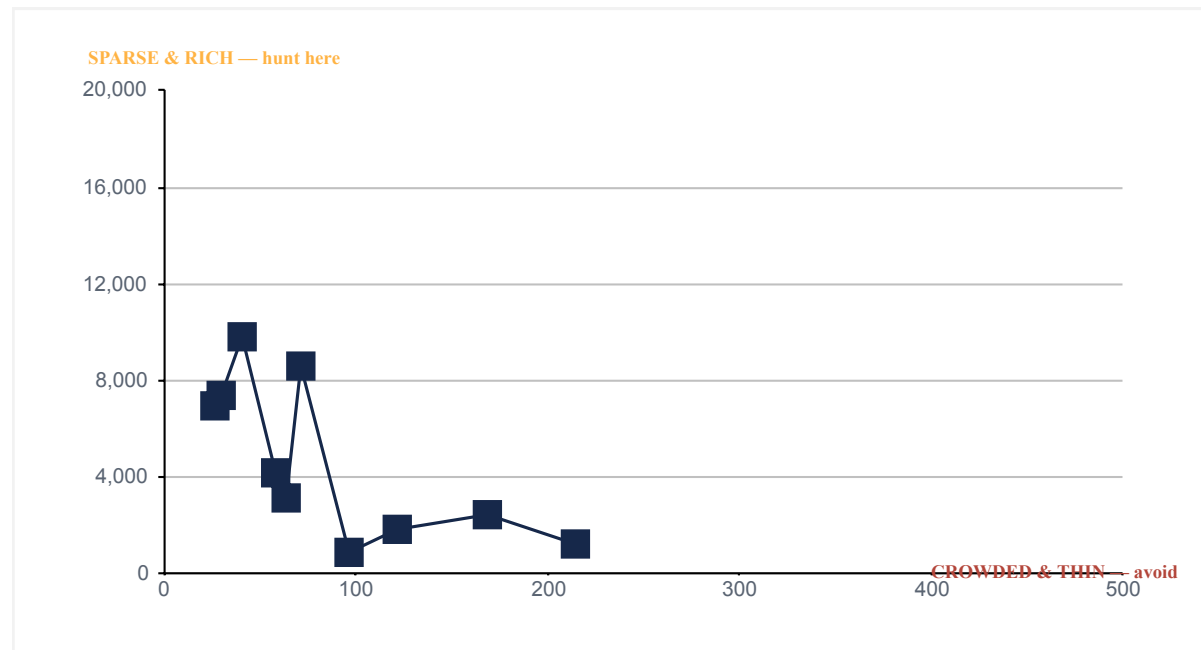
Fewer than ten listings and the median is noise — fold them into an 'Other' bubble.

Expect the reordering

Fintech, Security and Sales tooling should sit higher than their listing counts suggest; consumer AI utilities low and far right.

What the quadrant really measures

Build difficulty. Where a build needs domain knowledge rather than an API key, the built asset holds value.



Columns: category, revenue_12m_usd, mrr_usd, record_id. Calculation: per category count, median revenue, total revenue; bubble size = total category revenue; log scale on both axes.

Supply is global; revenue is not — geography predicts monetisation far more than it predicts output.

SO WHAT Building capability has globalised faster than pricing power. Read a founder's country as a signal about pricing confidence and payment infrastructure, not about product quality.

Rank by listing count

Rank by median 12-month revenue (US\$)

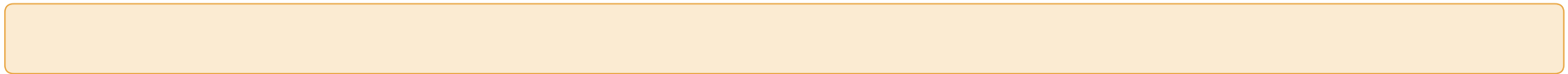
THE REORDERING IS THE INSIGHT The mechanism is pricing, not capability: the same product sold into US buyers earns a multiple of what it earns sold domestically elsewhere. A strong product with weak geographic pricing is an improvable asset.

Columns: country, revenue_12m_usd, mrr_usd, asking_price_usd. Calculation: count by ISO-2 country; median revenue restricted to countries with n ≥ 15; report blank-country rows as 'Undisclosed'. Values illustrative.

04

Business model analysis

How a business charges matters more than what it sells



Subscription businesses convert revenue into recurring revenue at several times the rate of one-time and credit models — the pricing model is the asset.

SO WHAT Revenue that does not recur transfers poorly. Pay a multiple for a recurring revenue ratio above ~0.8; pay a price for anything below it.

RECURRING REVENUE RATIO

$$\text{RRR} = (\text{mrr_usd} \times 12) \div \text{revenue_12m_usd}$$

What share of last year's revenue is locked in as of today. Capped at 2.0 to contain growth distortion.

The test in one sentence

\$60K a year with \$5K MRR scores 1.0 and is genuinely recurring.

\$60K a year with zero MRR sells something one-time and starts every month from zero.

Why buyers should care

One-time revenue is an earnings stream that resets the day the founder stops promoting it.

Report n on every bar

pricing_model is sparsely populated and needs keyword normalisation first — several buckets will be thin.

Columns: pricing_model (normalise first), mrr_usd, revenue_12m_usd, active_subscriptions, revenue_30d_usd. Calculation: RRR per listing where revenue_12m_usd > 0; median by bucket. Values illustrative.

B2B earns per customer; B2C earns per crowd — two different games with two different risk profiles.

SO WHAT B2B assets carry concentration risk and pricing power; B2C assets carry churn risk and volume. Match the acquisition thesis to the operating capability of the buyer.

Median ARPU (US\$ per subscription per month)

Median active subscribers



The concentration flag

A B2B listing with \$2,000 MRR across three subscriptions is not a business — it is three relationships with the departing founder, and those rarely survive transfer.

The diligence question changes sides

B2B buys pricing power at the cost of transfer risk. B2C at the same MRR across 400 subscriptions has no single churn event that moves the number.

Columns: audience_type, mrr_usd, active_subscriptions, revenue_12m_usd. Calculation: $ARPU = mrr_usd \div active_subscriptions$ where subs > 0; flag listings with subs < 10 and MRR > \$500. Values illustrative.

The customer you choose sets the ceiling you can reach — personas with a professional budget and a recurring workflow sustain the largest subscriber bases.

SO WHAT Buy into personas where the product sits inside a paid workflow. A tool a marketer opens every Monday retains; a tool a hobbyist opens once does not.

Developers, marketers and agencies expense software without a decision cycle. Consumers churn the moment the novelty fades.

Large early revenue, thin subscription counts — the pattern shows up repeatedly in the data.

Flag high ARPU with low scale

Median ARPU high but subscriptions under 20 means high value, low scale and high transfer risk.

This clustering is judgement

target_persona is founder-written free text. Publish the bucket rules on a backup slide so the analysis is auditable.

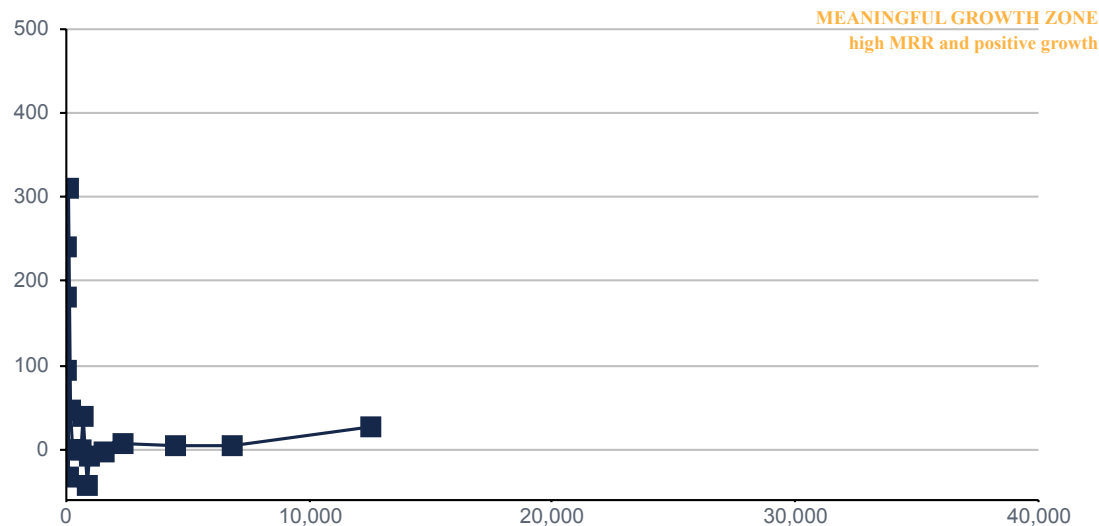
05

Revenue & growth

Separating momentum from noise, and audience from monetisation

The fastest growth rates belong to the smallest businesses: growth without an absolute base is noise, not momentum.

SO WHAT Screen on absolute revenue added, not percentage growth. A business going from \$20 to \$60 MRR is not outgrowing one adding \$4,000 a month.



$mrr - (mrr + (1 + growth))$. Percentages flatter the smallest listings and hide the real compounders.

Where total revenue rises but MRR does not, the business sold something one-time — a lifetime deal, a bulk pack, a service engagement.

Why that matters for price

A buyer valuing that month at a multiple is paying twelve times for something that happened once.

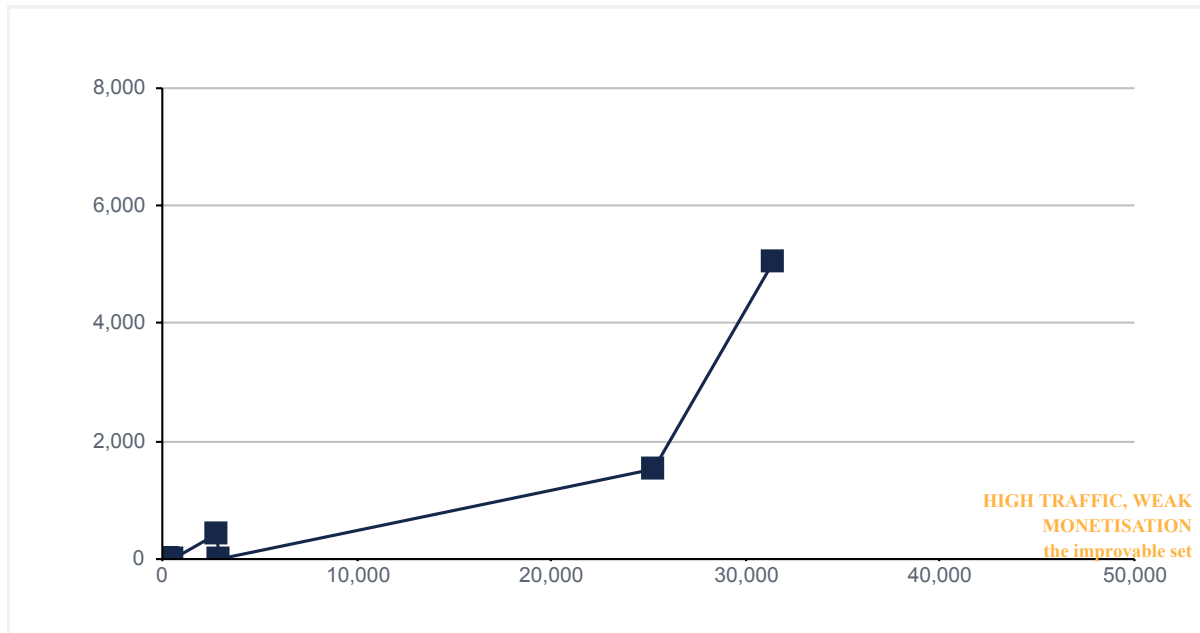
Handle -100% separately

Churned-to-zero rows destroy averages. Exclude and report as their own group.

Columns: mrr_usd, mrr_growth_30d_pct, revenue_growth_30d_pct, revenue_30d_usd, startup_name, category. Points shown are real observations from the visible sample; full scatter to be computed.

Traffic is necessary but nowhere near sufficient — high-traffic listings routinely earn less than low-traffic ones.

SO WHAT Do not pay for visitors. Pay for the rate at which visitors become revenue — and treat weak monetisation on strong traffic as the most improvable profile in the market.



visitors_30d is sparsely populated. With data this thin, a confident correlation coefficient would be dishonest.

Rank correlation is far more robust to the power law established earlier.

Real audience, weak extraction. Acquiring traffic is expensive; converting it is a pricing decision.

Read the lower-right carefully

High revenue on almost no traffic usually means direct sales or an app store — the traffic column simply is not capturing the channel.

Columns: visitors_30d, revenue_30d_usd, revenue_per_visitor_usd, domain_rating. Calculation: Pearson on log-transformed values plus Spearman rank; restrict to rows where both are non-null and non-zero; state n on the chart.

A visitor is worth an order of magnitude more in some categories than others — the same audience monetises radically differently.

SO WHAT Use revenue per visitor as the underwriting yardstick. It normalises for scale and exposes whether a business is efficient or merely large.

Rebuild the column before using it

revenue_per_visitor_usd is largely empty, but its two inputs are present far more often. Recompute and the usable sample expands materially.

Willingness to pay drives the spread

B2B tooling, security and fintech at the top; consumer entertainment at the bottom. Nothing about product quality is involved.

Use it as a diligence benchmark

A target below its category median is either a pricing problem you can fix or a traffic-quality problem you cannot.

Distinguishing the two

That is the core diligence question for any traffic-led asset.

06

Valuation insights

The pivot: how this market actually sets its prices

The platform's headline multiple annualises a single month of revenue. This is the largest single source of mispricing in the market.

revenue_multiple = asking_price_usd ÷ (revenue_30d_usd × 12)

VERIFIED TO THE DECIMAL
across five listings

Listing	Asking price	Revenue, last 30d	Computed	Platform states
Last Followed	\$130,000	\$7,202	1.50x	1.5x
Writing9	\$200,000	\$5,372	3.10x	3.0x
Eloking	\$300,000	\$5,055	4.95x	4.9x
ChurchCalls.ai	\$50,000	\$191	21.8x	21.8x
Decodex Mobile App	\$4,900	\$2.99	136.6x	136.6x

The correction

Corrected multiple = asking_price_usd ÷ revenue_12m_usd

Never screen on the platform multiple. Recompute every multiple on twelve months of revenue, and treat the gap between the two as a ranked list of mispriced assets. A business with one bad month appears to trade at a punitive multiple; one with a single lifetime-deal spike appears to be a bargain. Neither has anything to do with the underlying business.

The zero trap

Where last-month revenue is zero, the multiple displays as 0.0x. That is undefined, not cheap.

Anyone sorting the marketplace by multiple ascending is sorting straight into the worst assets on the platform.

Distortion index

revenue_12m ÷ (revenue_30d × 12)

Above 1: the last month was weak, so the asset looks more expensive than it is.

Below 1: the last month spiked, so it looks cheaper than it is.

Rank the whole market by this and you have a list of mispriced assets.

All five worked examples are actual dataset values. Columns: asking_price_usd, revenue_30d_usd, revenue_12m_usd, revenue_multiple, on_sale. Replicate across the full for-sale set and report the match rate.

On corrected multiples the market has no consistent price — comparable businesses trade across a several-fold range.

SO WHAT Dispersion is the opportunity. In a market with no price consensus, a buyer with a consistent valuation method has a structural edge over sellers pricing on intuition.

Some dispersion is real

A recurring B2B asset should command more than a one-time consumer app. That premium is legitimate, not an error.

Much of it is not

Founders anchor on effort, hope, or a number they read on a social feed.

Cross-check against run-rate

$\text{asking_price} \div (\text{mrr} \times 12)$. Where the two multiples diverge sharply, revenue is not recurring.

Bring one method to every listing

Corrected multiple, adjusted for RRR, then negotiate against the seller's anchor rather than around it.

Columns: asking_price_usd, revenue_12m_usd, revenue_3m_usd, mrr_usd, category, on_sale. Restrict to on_sale = TRUE and revenue_12m_usd > 0; report count excluded for having a price but no annual revenue. Values illustrative.

Domain authority predicts revenue but not price — the one genuinely non-replicable asset is being given away.

SO WHAT Weight domain rating in your own valuation even though the market does not. It is the only asset in a micro-business that cannot be rebuilt in a weekend.

Domain rating vs. price paid

Domain rating vs. revenue earned

Flat — the market does not pay for it

Steep — it strongly predicts revenue

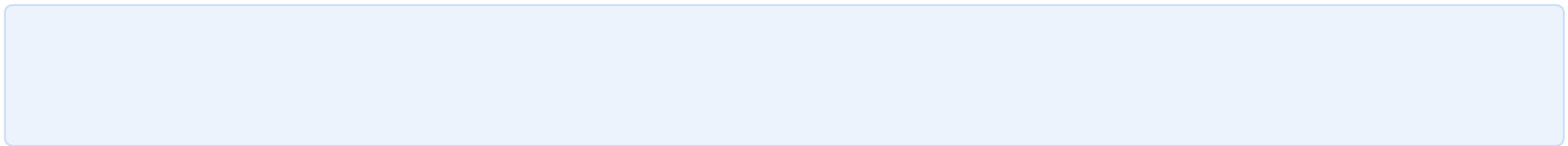
THE ASYMMETRY IS THE ARGUMENT An attribute that predicts revenue but not price is the textbook definition of underpriced. A DR-30 domain represents years of accumulated links a new owner cannot buy or shortcut, and it makes every future product launched on it cheaper to distribute. Separately: test x_followers — the dataset contains a listing with 52,000 followers and effectively no revenue.

Columns: domain_rating, asking_price_usd, revenue_12m_usd, visitors_30d, x_followers, category. Calculation: correlation of DR with corrected multiple vs. with revenue and visitors; medians by DR band. Values illustrative.

07

Acquisition opportunities

From 1,000 listings to a shortlist you can diligence



Four sequential filters reduce 1,000 listings to a shortlist small enough to diligence properly.

SO WHAT The screen is the deliverable. It survives this dataset and can be re-run on the platform monthly as new listings appear.



Columns: on_sale, revenue_12m_usd, mrr_usd, active_subscriptions, domain_rating, visitors_30d, asking_price_usd, category. Run a $\pm 20\%$ sensitivity on each threshold; if the shortlist swings wildly, widen them. Counts illustrative.

A small set combines recurring revenue, real traffic and a corrected multiple below its category median — these are the market's genuine opportunities.

SO WHAT These warrant diligence. Each is undervalued for a specific and stateable reason, not because it is cheap.

Listing	Category	ARR	Corrected	Platform	RRR	DR	Why undervalued
[Target 1]	Fintech	\$—	—x	—x	—	—	Soft trailing month distorts platform multiple
[Target 2]	Security	\$—	—x	—x	—	—	Under-monetised traffic vs. category RPV
[Target 3]	SaaS	\$—	—x	—x	—	—	Domain strength not reflected in price
[Target 4]	Analytics	\$—	—x	—x	—	—	High RRR, priced as a one-time asset
[Target 5]	Sales	\$—	—x	—x	—	—	Subscriber base well above category median

Rank by dollars, not by multiple

Value gap = (category median corrected multiple - listing corrected multiple) × revenue_12m

Ranking on dollars of mispricing correctly favours larger assets over cheap noise.

The profile to look for

A business whose last thirty days were soft for a visible reason while twelve-month revenue and subscriber base held steady. The platform multiple punishes it; the corrected multiple does not.

Cap the table at 8–10 rows — a board cannot act on more.

Table to be populated from the Slide 19 survivors, ranked by value gap. Columns: startup_name, category, country, revenue_12m_usd, mrr_usd, asking_price_usd, revenue_multiple, active_subscriptions, domain_rating, visitors_30d.

And the assets to walk away from — comparable listings at several times their category median, plus a large block advertising a meaningless 0.0x.

SO WHAT Overpricing here is usually structural, not greedy. Founders anchor on a single strong month, and the platform's arithmetic amplifies it.

Listings displaying 0.0x — asking price against actual trailing revenue



These are real dataset rows

Every one carries a genuine asking price, zero revenue in the last thirty days, and a platform multiple of 0.0x.

Be fair to the sellers

Most overpricing is not deception — it is a founder extrapolating their best month, and a platform that does the extrapolation automatically.

The zero-substance flag

Asking price above \$1,000 with no annual revenue and no subscriptions. Priced on hope.

The screening consequence

Any automated screen sorting on multiple ascending will surface precisely the wrong assets first.

Listings shown are actual dataset rows with `revenue_multiple = 0.0x` and a positive asking price. Also compute: corrected multiple above category p90 where `revenue_12m_usd > 0`; sum of asking prices behind the 0.0x block.

08

Recommendations

What founders and investors should do differently on Monday

Valuation is set by recurring revenue, subscriber count and domain strength — the three things most founders instrument last.

SO WHAT Five moves, each traceable to evidence in this deck. One of them changes the headline valuation without changing the business at all.

Move	Why it pays	Evidence	Horizon
Convert one-time pricing to subscription	RRR is the single largest driver of the corrected multiple	Slide 10	6–12 months
Grow subscriber count, not just revenue	Concentration destroys transfer value in diligence	Slide 11	6–12 months
Sell to budget-holding personas	Professional buyers retain; consumers churn on novelty	Slide 12	Strategic
Protect the last 90 days before listing	The platform multiple reads only the trailing 30 days	Slide 16	Immediate
Invest in the domain, not just the product	DR predicts revenue and is not priced into the ask	Slide 18	12+ months

LEAD WITH ROW FOUR Because the platform annualises the trailing thirty days, the month a founder chooses to list can move the headline valuation by a large factor with no change to the business. That is not gaming the system — it is the same discipline as not selling a seasonal business in its off-season.

Quantify row four before presenting: median difference between platform and corrected multiple, expressed as the valuation swing a single weak month produces.

WHAT SHOULD A BUYER DO DIFFERENTLY?

Replace the platform's multiple with a four-part underwriting standard, and this market becomes systematically screenable.



Columns: asking_price_usd, revenue_12m_usd, mrr_usd, active_subscriptions, domain_rating, category. Weights are a starting position, not a finding.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

A new asset class has become liquid before it has become efficiently priced — and that gap is the opportunity.

1 The market is a power law

Roughly half of listings have no revenue; the top decile carries the overwhelming majority. Listing counts describe enthusiasm

SLIDE 6

2 The headline multiple annualises one month

SLIDE 16

4 Traffic does not equal revenue

Monetisation quality dominates audience size. High traffic with low monetisation is the most improvable profile in the market.

SLIDE 14

5 Domain authority predicts revenue but not price

The one genuinely non-replicable asset in a micro-business is not being paid for.

SLIDE 18

Liquidity has arrived in this market ahead of pricing efficiency. Participants who bring a consistent method will capture that gap.

- Build recurring revenue early — it is the multiple
- Diversify subscribers to survive diligence
- Sell to budget-holders, not browsers
- Manage the trailing 30 days before listing
- Recompute every multiple on twelve months
- Screen on recurring revenue before price
- Treat sub-25-subscriber B2B revenue as founder relationships
- Bid for domain strength the market is not charging for
- Re-run the screen monthly — the inefficiency is structural
- Shortlist ranked by dollar value gap, not by multiple
- Strongest profile: steady twelve-month revenue with a soft trailing month
- Punished by the platform's arithmetic, unharmed in fundamentals
- Second tier: real traffic, weak monetisation, fixable by pricing

INTERPRETING THIS DATASET

Sparsity Traffic, category, pricing and persona are populated for a

The 0.0x trap A zero multiple means zero trailing revenue, not a

Self-authored fields Revenue is API-verified; category and persona are founder-written marketing copy.

Point-in-time Frozen 30 July 2026. Thirty-day metrics are volatile by construction.